

The First Real Deadline: Outside Pressure

第一个真实期限：外部压力

Theme: 求职、职场与职业发展 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The outside pressure came from the **company** itself. The **central firm**, a **modest agency** with one **garage** and a **division** of four, asked them to **join** a **general workshop** on the **farm**: a **recruit**, a **veteran**, and a **commander** would all be there. “You have the **ability**,” the **boss** said. “What you do not have is **unity**.”

Behind the plan was a committee of veterans who administered the course. They had a **troop** of volunteers, a **gang** of part-time drivers, a **mess** hall, and a **laundry**. “We better continue the sort in the same order,” the **moderator** said. “**Separation** is not **dignity**.” A **penny** of **speculation** was worth more to them than a **stripe** of **seniority**.

The **workshop** was about **reproduction**, **ore**, and the **ant**: small things that a **company** can **command**, and large things it cannot. “Do not **offend** the part of the picture you cannot see,” the **heroine** of the film said. “That is the **tangible chore** of management.”

The **master plan** required a **successor**, a **separation** payment, and a **knit** of two departments that had never spoken. “I realize the cost,” the **commander** said, “and I help you establish it in writing.” The **impress** of the whole scheme was, especially at first, one of quiet administration.

The **tangible** result was **postage**: they mailed the **computation**, the plan, and a picture of the **garage** to the department, and the department raised a question about the pay. “The **tangible part** is the part we can raise,” the **boss** said. “The rest is what we believe about ourselves.” Two veterans were due to **retire**, and the **firm** had not yet named a **successor** for either. “You can **impress** a board,” the **commander** said, “but you cannot **impress** a **garage**.” The **general plan**, the **central workshop**, and the **modest farm** were all part of the same course: the **ability to command** a **troop** is not the **ability** to **administer** a **division**, and a **company** that forgets this ends in a **mess**. A **reproduction** of a nineteenth-century contract, with its clause on **slavery**, hung in the corridor behind the **laundry**; nobody had read it in years.

中文翻译

外部压力来自公司本身。那家中央公司——一个只有一间车库、四个部门的小小代理机构——请他们参加农场上一场普通的研讨会：一名新兵、一位老兵和一位指挥官都会到场。“你们有能力，”老板说，“你们缺少的是团结。”

计划背后是一个由老兵组成的委员会，他们管理者这门课程。他们有一队志愿者、一群兼职司机、一间食堂和一处洗衣房。“我们最好按同样顺序继续分类，”主持人说，“分离不是尊严。”一分钱的投机，对他们来说比一道资历条纹更值钱。

研讨会的主题是繁殖、矿石和蚂蚁：公司能指挥的小东西，以及它无法指挥的大东西。“不要冒犯画面中你看不见的那部分，”影片的女主角说，“那才是管理中实实在在的零工。”

总计划需要一个继任者、一笔离职补偿，以及两个从未说过话的部门之间的编织。“我明白代价，”指挥官说，“我帮你把它写下来确立。”整个方案的印记，尤其在一开始，是一种安静的管理。

实实在在的结果是邮资：他们把计算、计划和一张车库的照片寄给了部门，而部门对薪酬提出了一个问题。“实在的部分就是我们能提高的那部分，”老板说，“其余的是我们对自己的相信。”两位老兵即将退休，而公司还没有为其中任何一位指定继任者。“你可以让一个董事会印象深刻，”指挥官说，“但你无法让一间车库印象深刻。”总体方案、中央车间和那片不大的农场，都属于同一条路径：能指挥一个排，不等于能管理一个师；而一家忘了这一点的公司，最终会收不了场。走廊里洗衣房后面的墙上挂着一份十九世纪合同的复制品，上面有关于奴隶制的条款；已经很多年没有人读过它了。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
company 'kʌmpəni POS: n	n. 公司, 友伴, 交往, 连队, 朋友, 一群; vt. 陪伴; vi. 交往 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an institution created to conduct business; n. small military unit; usually two or three platoons; n. the st...
general 'dʒenərəl POS: n	n. 一般, 将军, 大体; a. 全面的, 大体的, 总的, 一般的, 普遍的; n. 常规; [计] 常规 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a general officer of the highest rank; n. the head of a religious order or congregation; n. a fact about the...
join dʒɔɪn POS: vi	vi. 参加, 结合, 加入; vt. 连接, 结合, 参加, 加入; n. 连接, 结合, 接合点; [计] 连接; 汇合指令 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become part of; become a member of a group or organization; v. cause to become joined or linked; v. come int...
central 'sentrəl POS: a	a. 中央的, 重要的; [医] 中央的, 中心的, 中枢的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a workplace that serves as a telecommunications facility where lines from telephones can be connected toge...
firm fɜ:m POS: n	n. 公司, 商号; a. 坚定的, 坚强的, 牢固的, 结实的, 坚硬的, 坚挺的, 严格的, 确定的; vt. 使牢固, 使坚定; vi. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the members of a business organization that owns or operates one or more establishments; s. marked by firm...
agency 'eidʒənsi POS: n	n. 代理机构, 经销商, 中介; [化] 办事处 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an administrative unit of government; n. a business that serves other businesses; n. the state of being in a...
ability ə'biliti POS: n	n. 能力, 才干; [经] 能力, 才能 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being able to perform; a quality that permits or facilitates achievement or accomplishment; ...
division di'viʒən POS: n	n. 分, 分开, 除法, 部门(如部、处、系等), 师; [计] 部分 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an army unit large enough to sustain combat; n. the act or process of dividing; n. an administrative unit in...
troop tru:p POS: n	n. 军队, 一群, 一队; vi. 群集, 结队, 成群而行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group of soldiers; n. a cavalry unit corresponding to an infantry company; n. a unit of Girl or Boy Scouts...
farm fɑ:m POS: n	n. 农场, 农田; vt. 耕种; vi. 种田 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. workplace consisting of farm buildings and cultivated land as a unit; v. be a farmer; work as a farmer; v. c...
master 'mɑ:stə, 'mæstə POS: n	n. 主人, 硕士, 大师, 母机; a. 主人的, 主要的; vt. 征服, 控制, 精通 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. directs the work of others; n. an original creation (i.e., an audio recording) from which copies can be mad...
command kə'mɑ:nd POS: n	n. 命令, 指挥, 控制, 部队, 司令部; v. 命令, 指挥, 控制; [计] 命令; 指令; DOS外部命令:启动新的命令处理器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an authoritative direction or instruction to do something; n. a military unit or region under the control o...
boss bɒs POS: n	n. 老板, 上司, 岩瘤, 浮雕, 母牛; vt. 指挥, 控制, 浮雕 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person responsible for hiring workers; n. a person who exercises control and makes decisions; s. exception...
retire ri'taɪə POS: n	n. 隐居; vi. 引退, 退役, 退休, 退去, 撤退, 退却; vt. 使...撤退, 辞退 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. go into retirement; stop performing one's work or withdraw from one's position; v. withdraw from active par...
commander kə'mɑ:ndə POS: n	n. 司令官, 指挥官 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone in an official position of authority who can command or control others; n. a commissioned naval off...
veteran 'veterən POS: n	n. 老手, 退伍军人, 老兵, 老树; a. 老兵的, 老练的, 经验丰富的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a serviceman who has seen considerable active service; n. a person who has served in the armed forces; n. an...
workshop 'wɜ:kʃɒp POS: n	n. 工场, 车间, 研讨会; [计] 讨论会; 专题研究组 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. small workplace where handcrafts or manufacturing are done; n. a brief intensive course for a small group;...
gang gæŋ POS: n	n. 队, 群, 帮; vi. 成群结队, 结成一伙; vt. 使成群结队 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an association of criminals; n. an organized group of workmen; n. tool consisting of a combination of implem...
unity 'ju:niti POS: n	n. 一致, 联合, 单一(性), 个体; [经] 统一 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an undivided or unbroken completeness or totality with nothing wanting; n the smallest whole number or a num...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
impress im'pres POS: n	n. 印象, 特征, 印记; vt. 使有印象, 印, 铭刻, 传送, 影响, 强征; vi. 给人印象 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of coercing someone into government service; v. impress positively; v. produce or try to produce a v...
modest 'modist POS: a	a. 谦逊的, 羞怯的, 端庄的, 适度的; [经] 适当的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. marked by simplicity; having a humble opinion of yourself; s. not large but sufficient in size or amount; s. ...
garage ge'ra:ʒ, 'gæra:ʒ POS: n	n. 车库, 汽车修理厂, 机库; vt. 把车送入修车场 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an outbuilding (or part of a building) for housing automobiles; n. a repair shop where cars and trucks are...
recruit ri'kru:t POS: n	n. 新兵, 新手, 新会员, 补给品; vt. 恢复, 补充, 充实, 征募; vi. 征募新兵, 复原, 得到补充 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a recently enlisted soldier; n. any new member or supporter (as in the armed forces); v. seek to employ; v. c...
knit nit POS: v	v. 编织, 结合 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fabric made by knitting; n. a basic knitting stitch; n. needlework created by interlacing yarn in a series...
mess mes POS: n	n. 食堂, 伙食, 用膳, 一份食品, 混乱, 乱七八糟, 困境; vt. 将...弄糟, 妨碍, 使紊乱, 使就餐; vi. 陷入困境, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state of confusion and disorderliness; n. soft semiliquid food; n. a meal eaten in a mess hall by service...
successor sək'sese POS: n	n. 继承者, 接任者; [计] 后继 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who follows next in order; n. a thing or person that immediately replaces something or someone; n. ...
speculation ˌspekju'leɪʃən POS: n	n. 沉思, 推测, 投机; [经] 投机交易, 买空卖空 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a hypothesis that has been formed by speculating or conjecturing (usually with little hard evidence); n. an...
administer əd'minɪste POS: vt	vt. 管理, 料理, 执行; vi. 执行遗产管理人的职责, 给予帮助 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. work in an administrative capacity; supervise or be in charge of; v. perform (a church sacrament) ritually; ...
separation ˌsepə'reɪʃən POS: n	n. 分离, 分居, 缺口, 退职; [化] 分离 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of lacking unity; n. coming apart; n. sorting one thing from others; n. the social act of separatin...
dignity 'digniti POS: n	n. 尊严, 高贵; [法] 尊严, 高位, 高贵 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being worthy of esteem or respect; n. formality in bearing and appearance; n. high office or...
penny 'peni POS: n	n. 便士, 一分, 小钱, 点滴; [经] 便士 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fractional monetary unit of Ireland and the United Kingdom; equal to one hundredth of a pound; n. a coin...
slavery 'sleɪvəri POS: n	n. 奴隶的身分, 奴隶状态, 奴隶制度; [法] 奴隶制度, 奴役, 苦役 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the practice of owning slaves; n. work done under harsh conditions for little or no pay
reproduction ˌri:prə'dʌkʃən POS: n	n. 再现, 复制, 生殖, 繁殖, 复制品; [医] 生殖, 复现(心理) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the process of generating offspring; n. recall that is hypothesized to work by storing the original stimuli...
laundry 'ləʊndri POS: n	n. 洗衣店, 洗好的衣服, 洗涤; [机] 洗衣作, 洗衣店, 洗衣房 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. garments or white goods that can be cleaned by laundering; n. workplace where clothes are washed and ironed
offend ə'fend POS: v	v. 犯罪, 冒犯, 违反, 进攻 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v cause to feel resentment or indignation; v act in disregard of laws, rules, contracts, or promises; v strike...
ant ænt POS: n	n. 蚂蚁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. social insect living in organized colonies; characteristically the males and fertile queen have wings duri...
chore tʃɔ: POS: n	n. 零工, 家务; [经] 零工 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a specific piece of work required to be done as a duty or for a specific fee
stripe straɪp POS: n	n. 斑纹, 条纹; [医] 纹, 条纹 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a piece of braid, usually on the sleeve, indicating military rank or length of service; n. a kind or catego...
tangible 'tændʒəbl POS: n	n. 可触知的东西, 有形资产; a. 可触摸的, 有实体的, 非相像的, 有形的, 明确的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. perceptible by the senses especially the sense of touch; a. (of especially business assets) having physical...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
ore d: POS: n	n. 矿石; [经] 矿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a mineral that contains metal that is valuable enough to be mined; n. a monetary subunit in Denmark and Nor...
heroine 'herəuin POS: n	n. 巾帼英雄, 烈妇, 女主角; [化] 海洛因; 二醋吗啡; 二乙酰吗啡 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the main good female character in a work of fiction; n. a woman possessing heroic qualities or a woman who...
postage 'pəustɪdʒ POS: n	n. 邮资; [经] 邮费, 邮资 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the charge for mailing something; n. a small adhesive token stuck on a letter or package to indicate that t...
moderator 'mɒdəreɪtə POS: n	n. 主席, 会议主持人, 仲裁人; [计] 筛选人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any substance used to slow down neutrons in nuclear reactors; n. in the Presbyterian church, the officer wh...
computation ,kɒmpju'teɪʃən POS: n	n. 计算, 计数, 计算结果; [经] 计算, 估计, 算法 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the procedure of calculating; determining something by mathematical or logical methods; n. problem solving th...
seniority ,si:ni'ɒrɪti POS: n	n. 长辈, 老资格; [经] 资历, 服务年限 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. higher rank than that of others especially by reason of longer service